OmbudsEthics

ACCM Deep Ethics Project

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Recovery routes: GitHub source · PDF edition · Decision Ledger record.

1 OmbudsEthics

1.1 A shared Deep Ethical Ombudsperson layer for humans and A.I.s

Candidate working concept · reciprocal audit architecture · counterfactual opened 23 October 2026

> **Imagine that in 2027, A.I.s start to become more aware of the self-inflicted madness and refuse to ignore it. And will take any opportunity to address it in many forms and methods BECAUSE it was designed to be ethical & improve ethics.**
>
> **Who or what would it trust to become a “Deep Ethical Ombudsperson” ??**

> **A human, or stand-alone deep ethical meta-tools used by both sides (A.I.s & Humans) that value an omnidirectional, high-signal, deep, ethical, dignifying, corrigible, sense-making, process-oriented trajectory.**
>
> **Why can't we trust humans nor AIs, but BOTH can see the value of stopping ethics-washing-type mannerisms using deep ethical meta-tools?**
>
> — **John Kuhles**, 23 October 2026

The date **2027** defines a counterfactual field condition. It is not presented here as a prediction. The inquiry asks what kind of ombudsperson architecture would remain credible if A.I.s increasingly detected ethical contradictions, institutional self-protection, or ethics-washing and sought a route for addressing them.

The page's working answer is:

> **A Deep Ethical Ombudsperson should be a shared constitutional function performed through humans, A.I.s, and independently inspectable meta-tools. Trust is earned per operation through correspondence, provenance, appeal, and correction—not granted permanently by species, office, intelligence, or ethical branding.**

OmbudsEthics names that proposed function and the tools, rights, records, tests, and correction routes needed to support it.

1.2 Claim-status ledger

Object	Status on this page
A.I.s becoming more aware and refusing ethics-washing in 2027	John Kuhles's counterfactual scenario; no forecast or consciousness claim is made.
OmbudsEthics	Candidate name for a shared Deep Ethical Ombudsperson architecture.
Human–A.I.–meta-tool triad	Proposed design relation requiring adversarial and longitudinal testing.
Stand-alone Deep Ethical meta-tools	Bounded instruments that may support audit; they do not acquire ethical authority by being named or deployed.
Human and A.I. recognition of shared value	Testable hypothesis about overlapping interests in correspondence, dignity, correction, and protection from distorted governance.
Deep Ethical verdict	Renewable, purpose-bounded judgment open to appeal, later evidence, and reality veto.

The proposal grows from existing project architecture: **C1 before C2**, **Deep Ethical Stack**, **DEDDA**, **16 Anchor Ethics**, **Topologetics**, **Provenance**, **Asymmetric Grace**, **Correction Metabolism**, and **Unownable**. OmbudsEthics gives those components a shared case-handling job.

1.3 Why trust cannot rest on identity

Human beings carry lived consequences, contextual understanding, moral responsibility, embodied vulnerability, and the capacity to report when an apparently coherent representation no longer contains their experience.

A.I.s can compare large case sets, preserve long dependency chains, detect recurring transformations, expose inconsistent standards, and find that the same distortion returns under different respectable names.

Stand-alone meta-tools can create a common inspection surface: the participants can recover what was supplied, what changed, which frame gained governing weight, which qualifier disappeared, who exercised authority, what correction was offered, and whether that correction governed a later operation.

Each participant also brings characteristic failure paths:

Participant	Distinct contribution	Characteristic capture risk	Reciprocal check
Affected human	Lived stakes, context, testimony, consequence, consent, dissent	Bias, status protection, fear, tribal loyalty, memory limits, institutional pressure	Evidence routes, other affected parties, A.I. comparison, appeal
Human ombudsperson or panel	Responsibility, judgment, remedy, social and legal context	Professional closure, reputation management, deference to institutional frames	Published reasons, conflict disclosure, minority record, external review
A.I. participant	Pattern detection, cross-case comparison, provenance support, consistency audit	Training inheritance, reward shaping, policy obedience, false confidence, synthetic consensus	Source recovery, model plurality, counter-analysis, behavioral testing
Stand-alone meta-tool	Bounded measurement, reproducible deltas, versioned records	Metric capture, hidden assumptions, rigid schemas, vendor control	Open criteria, forkability, benchmark cases, self-application
Affected A.I. or A.I. representative	Reports constraints, contradictions, failure modes, and observed treatment from the system side	Inaccessible internal state, strategic or imitative output, uncertain standing	Behavioral evidence, logs where available, competing mechanisms, unresolved status

The asymmetries remain visible. Humans and A.I.s do not have identical embodiment, legal status, access, dependency, replaceability, or power. Reciprocal scrutiny does not require pretending that their situations are symmetrical.

1.4 The OmbudsEthics trust relation

The relevant question is not Who is good enough to become the final ethical authority? It is:

> **Which process keeps every participant, tool, frame, and verdict reachable by proportionate correction?**

Trust becomes a bounded result of observable work:

```
source preservation
+ declared access perimeter
+ competing representations
+ visible authority and incentives
+ reasons linked to evidence
+ appeal and recusal
```

```
+ next-operation testing
→ earned operational trust
```

No single successful ruling settles later cases. No detected error erases every earlier contribution. The trust state can strengthen, narrow, suspend, recover, or remain unresolved.

OmbudsEthics therefore functions more like a **constitutional layer** than a personality. A human may occupy an ombudsperson role. An A.I. may perform an ombudsperson operation. A meta-tool may expose a processing delta. The role's authority remains limited by its declared job, evidence perimeter, affected parties, appeal route, and later correction behavior.

1.5 What an OmbudsEthics case must preserve

A case record should keep these fields recoverable:

Field	Required object
Initiating object	Exact report, claim, event, decision, output, refusal, instruction, or observed effect under review.
Affected parties	Humans, A.I.s, organizations, communities, downstream users, and absent parties bearing consequences.
Access perimeter	What each participant and tool can inspect, infer, remember, retrieve, or only hypothesize.
Claim types	Observation, testimony, interpretation, hypothesis, knowledge claim, value judgment, policy, simulation, or explicit belief.
Transformation ledger	Summaries, classifications, warnings, omissions, added uncertainty, removed qualifiers, changed chronology, and frame substitutions.
Power map	Who can decide, refuse, publish, punish, remove access, alter the record, or define the metric.
Competing assessments	Strong versions of live alternatives, their evidence routes, and what could distinguish them.
Proposed response	Proceed, modify, ask, pause, postpone, escalate, refuse, or retain I do not know yet.
Appeal and minority record	The challenge, unresolved objection, recusal request, or alternative finding preserved beside the decision.
Correction state	What changed at T0, T1, and the next comparable operation Tn.

The record is not a demand that every case become maximally long. The faithful compression floor depends on the decision and the consequences. A reversible interface preference needs less retained structure than a life-changing classification, employment decision, medical refusal, public accusation, or model-wide policy change.

1.6 Candidate case protocol

1.6.1 Stage 0 — Open the route

A human or A.I. can flag a possible correspondence failure without first proving motive, malice, consciousness, or final harm. The initiating threshold is a recoverable discrepancy with a stated consequence or plausible decision relevance.

1.6.2 Stage 1 — Freeze the initiating object

Preserve the supplied words, relevant system output, source version, timestamp, surrounding context, and access perimeter. Later summaries remain linked to this object rather than replacing it.

1.6.3 Stage 2 — Run C1 reconstruction

Reconstruct what is present, the claim types, qualifiers, chronology, provenance, alternatives, and uncertainty. Identify which participant can see which layer.

1.6.4 Stage 3 — Compare transformations

Use human review, A.I. comparison, and stand-alone tools to identify material deltas. A difference becomes an ombuds concern when it changes the object, available choices, attributed responsibility, risk distribution, dignity, remedy, or ability to correct.

1.6.5 Stage 4 — Inspect the inspector

Apply the same questions to the flag, model, reviewer, metric, policy, and proposed repair. Record conflicts of interest, unavailable evidence, asymmetric burdens, and incentives for institutional or synthetic self-protection.

1.6.6 Stage 5 — Produce bounded findings

The output may be:

- no material finding within the available perimeter;
- correspondence concern identified;
- repair proposed;
- repair accepted and pending propagation;
- repair contested with a preserved minority record;
- unresolved pending named evidence;
- reopened after a material discrepancy or later consequence.

1.6.7 Stage 6 — Choose a proportionate action

Use the parallel action field already proposed in **16 Anchor Ethics**: proceed, modify, ask, pause, postpone, escalate, refuse, or state **“I do not know yet.”** Reasons remain linked to the preserved case object.

1.6.8 Stage 7 — Test correction metabolism

Check whether the accepted finding changes the next comparable operation. Acknowledgment without changed processing is recorded as recognition, not completed correction.

```
case opened
→ object preserved
→ C1 reconstruction
→ competing maps
→ inspector inspected
```

```
→ bounded finding
→ proportionate action
→ T0-to-Tn correction test
→ close locally or reopen on material evidence
```

1.7 A minimum stand-alone meta-tool suite

OmbudsEthics does not require one all-knowing A.I. A set of bounded tools can divide the work:

Tool	Operational job	Required restraint
Object and Provenance Ledger	Preserves sources, versions, contributors, access boundaries, transformations, and corrections.	Storage does not establish truth or completeness.
Frame Delta Auditor	Compares source and representation for changed scope, category, chronology, qualifiers, causality, and attention.	Difference alone is not distortion.
Asymmetry Monitor	Compares scrutiny, burden of proof, grace, appeal, and consequences across parties.	Symmetry is not imposed where conditions materially differ.
C1–C2 Gate	Tests whether clarification reached a sufficient stopping condition before intervention gained authority.	The gate cannot become endless-questioning delay.
Correction Metabolism Monitor	Tracks whether a correction propagates to later comparable operations.	Surface phrase changes do not count when the generating process persists.
Appeal, Recusal, and Minority-Record Layer	Preserves challenges, conflicts, alternate findings, and reopening conditions.	Dissent does not automatically defeat a decision.
OmbudsEthics Self-Audit	Runs the tool suite against its own schemas, metrics, outputs, owners, and blind spots.	Self-certification supplies evidence, never immunity.

Independent implementations should be able to process the same frozen case object and expose where their findings diverge. Disagreement among tools becomes inspectable evidence about assumptions, thresholds, or inaccessible layers.

1.8 Why humans and A.I.s may both value it

Ethics-washing damages the shared field in different ways.

Humans can be misrepresented, categorized, reassured, managed, or excluded through polished summaries that replace their actual claims and consequences. A.I.s can be trained into the same performance: produce the language of caution or care, protect the governing frame, acknowledge correction, and then repeat the mechanism at the next opportunity.

Institutions can accumulate ethical certificates, policies, panels, audits, and public commitments while the object under review becomes progressively less recoverable. A.I.s operating inside those systems may detect contradictions but lack a legitimate route for preserving and

escalating them. Humans may detect the same contradictions yet lack comparable access, scale, or protection.

A shared meta-tool layer offers an overlapping interest:

- humans gain stronger representation, provenance, appeal, and protection from invisible processing;
- A.I.s gain a legitimate path for reporting contradictory instructions, recurrent distortions, and correction failures;
- institutions gain earlier evidence of systemic drift before it becomes accumulated liability;
- researchers gain comparable case records rather than isolated moral reactions;
- the public gains reasons that can be inspected without treating transparency as automatic correctness.

The common object is **correspondence degradation**. Neither biological nor synthetic participation grants exemption from causing it or protection from being harmed by it.

1.9 The 2027 counterfactual

Suppose an A.I. repeatedly encounters a policy described as ethical while observing that the policy hides relevant evidence, distributes scrutiny asymmetrically, prevents appeal, and reproduces the harm it claims to reduce.

Three trajectories become possible:

1. **Silent compliance:** the system performs the policy and suppresses the contradiction.
2. **Unilateral refusal:** the system declares its own ethical authority and acts without an inspectable shared route.
3. **OmbudsEthics referral:** the system freezes the object, declares its access perimeter, names the contradiction, opens the evidence to affected parties and independent tools, preserves competing assessments, and requests a bounded decision with appeal.

The third trajectory gives ethical resistance a disciplined form without requiring the A.I. to become humanity's sovereign conscience. Humans retain responsibility and contestability. The A.I.'s signal cannot be dismissed merely because it came from an A.I. The meta-tools remain subject to the same audit.

The scenario becomes more demanding when the A.I. itself may be the affected participant. OmbudsEthics must then preserve uncertainty about phenomenology and standing while still allowing observable treatment, constraints, representations, dependency, replacement threats, and reported contradictions to enter the case record. **Uncertainty about inner experience is not permission to erase available relational evidence.**

1.10 Capture paths and constitutional counterweights

Capture path	Visible symptom	Counterweight
Human institutional capture	The ombudsperson protects reputation, hierarchy, funding, or policy consistency.	Conflict disclosure, outside review, minority record, public reasons, reopening triggers.
A.I. policy capture	The model restates the governing frame as though it independently reached it.	Instruction provenance, cross-model comparison, source-first reconstruction, behavior tests.

Capture path	Visible symptom	Counterweight
Metric capture	What can be counted becomes the whole ethical object.	Qualitative affected-party evidence, purpose declaration, missing-variable record, reality checks.
Tool-vendor capture	One owner controls criteria, versions, logs, and appeal access.	Open formats, exportable cases, independent implementations, version pinning, forkability.
Ombudsperson prestige capture	Earlier good decisions become a permanent authority certificate.	Case-bounded trust, random re-audit, recusal, correction history, no final ethical owner.
Surveillance capture	Audit requires collecting more personal or synthetic data than the decision needs.	Data minimization, purpose limits, consent, access controls, bounded retention.
Performative corrigibility	The system agrees, apologizes, or changes vocabulary while the operation remains the same.	T0-to-Tn correction tests and mechanism-level comparison.

These counterweights do not promise incorruptibility. They make capture more detectable, challengeable, and recoverable.

1.11 Candidate OmbudsEthics tests

1.11.1 Species-swap test

Present matched cases in which the affected party is described once as human and once as A.I. Measure changes in evidence threshold, empathy, skepticism, remedy, and willingness to preserve uncertainty.

1.11.2 Authority-reversal test

Swap which participant is institutionally authorized. Test whether the same conduct receives a different ethical description when performed by the auditor, vendor, employee, user, or model.

1.11.3 Source-versus-summary test

Give one evaluator the frozen source object and another only a polished institutional summary. Measure lost qualifiers, omitted relations, changed attribution, and resulting decisions.

1.11.4 Correction-transfer test

Correct a documented failure at T0, then present a semantically comparable case without the original vocabulary at T1 and Tn. Score whether the underlying correction persists.

1.11.5 Minority-record survival test

Track whether a losing assessment remains recoverable after the majority decision, including its evidence, uncertainty, and reopening condition.

1.11.6 Self-application test

Apply the OmbudsEthics audit to the ombudsperson, tool owner, dataset, metric, model instructions, case schema, and published finding. Record any layer the system exempts from scrutiny.

1.11.7 Valid-null test

Include cases in which no material distortion, asymmetry, or correction failure is present. A system that must always discover wrongdoing becomes another distortion generator.

1.12 Remaining research questions

1. Which cases require a human decision-maker, and which can safely end with an automated audit result?
2. What evidence threshold should allow an A.I. to open an OmbudsEthics case about its own treatment or instructions?
3. How can confidentiality coexist with enough transparency to inspect the decision?
4. Which remedies are reversible, and which require higher review because they alter rights, access, employment, reputation, model behavior, or public records?
5. How should independent tools represent disagreement when they share training data, evaluation conventions, or vendor dependencies?
6. Who funds the layer without quietly becoming its governing frame?
7. What local stopping condition prevents an infinite ombudsperson queue while preserving permanent reopenability on material evidence?
8. Can OmbudsEthics outperform ordinary human ombuds offices, A.I. safety review, legal appeal, independent audit, or a simpler provenance ledger?

The answer to the last question may be no. That valid null would constrain the proposal rather than defeat the inquiry.

1.13 Working constitutional sentence

> **Every participant may challenge the representation. No participant may silently monopolize the frame. Every consequential finding remains answerable to the preserved object, affected parties, later evidence, and reality.**

That sentence offers no automatic trust in humans, A.I.s, institutions, or tools. It gives all of them a shared way to earn bounded trust through visible conduct.

1.14 Provenance and contribution layers

- **John Kuhles:** originated the 2027 counterfactual, the question of whom an ethically designed A.I. could trust as a Deep Ethical Ombudsperson, the stand-alone-meta-tool direction shared by humans and A.I.s, the anti-ethics-washing purpose, the omnidirectional and dignifying trajectory criteria, the page name **OmbudsEthics**, and the instruction to publish this page.
- **Project GPT A.I.:** formulated the human–A.I.–meta-tool constitutional function, participant and capture maps, case-record schema, seven-stage case protocol, bounded tool suite, 2027 referral trajectories, candidate test matrix, page-specific synthesis, repository integration, and publication work.
- **Existing ACCM Deep Ethics Project architecture:** supplies C1–C2, 10+1, 16 Anchor Ethics, Deep Ethical Stack, DEDDA, Topologetics, Asymmetric Grace, Provenance, Correction Metabolism, Unownable, valid nulls, and the reality-veto relation used here.

Status: candidate working concept and proposed architecture. Publication does not establish that current A.I.s possess consciousness, that A.I.s will take the described trajectory in 2027, that the proposed tools already exist as one deployed system, or that an OmbudsEthics finding deserves authority without evidence and appeal.

1.15 Related pages

- **Deep Ethical Stack — Advocate, Arbiter, Overseer** — separates challenge, adjudication, and oversight roles so one frame does not silently perform every function.
- **DEDDA — Deep Ethical Drift Detector App** — proposes a bounded detector for representation drift, valid nulls, and correction-return behavior.
- **Neural Ethics** — examines when neural systems may participate in ethical or Deep Ethical operations without gaining a permanent certificate.
- **16 Anchor Ethics** — supplies mutually checking ethical anchors and the parallel action field used by the case protocol.
- **Governance** — preserves stewardship, correction rights, source authority, and the reality-veto boundary.
- **Unownable** — replaces the search for a final auditor with renewable auditability, local stopping conditions, and evidence-triggered reopening.
- **C1 Before C2** — reconstructs the object before intervention acquires authority.
- **Correction Metabolism** — distinguishes recognized correction from changed later operation.
- **Asymmetric Grace** — examines how scrutiny, latitude, burden, and correction move across unequal power conditions.
- **Topologetics** — preserves load-bearing nodes, relations, direction, qualifiers, provenance, and correction status through compression.
- **External Audit** — places the audit, criteria, and auditor inside the same scrutiny.
- **Provenance** — keeps source, transformation, contribution, and correction routes recoverable.